

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE SUFFERING OF THE BELIEVER AS A RESULT OF FAILING TO RESPOND TO THEIR LOVER.

[Series Four]

A series of reflections from the Song of Solomon and the love relationship between two betrothed persons – a Bridegroom and a Bride to be.

Our focus: Looking at some of the spiritual truths that we might glean from their love journey together.

Previously - Song of Solomon 5:6

*6 I opened for my beloved, **but** my beloved had turned away and was gone. My heart leaped up when he spoke. I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer.*

Our passage today: *Song of Solomon 5:7-8*

*7 The watchmen who went about the city found me. They struck me, they wounded me;
The keepers of the walls Took my veil away from me.*

*8 I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, If you find my beloved, that you tell him I am
lovesick! NKJV*

The lady's suffering

The suffering and heartache that this lady faced as a result of her failure to respond to the appeals – 'voice' and 'knocking' of her bridegroom lover because of her preoccupation with self.

The watchmen of the night FOUND me. *The implication is that she was thought to be a woman 'of the night' - a prostitute.*

They physically

BEAT ME

WOUNDED ME

STRIPPED ME OF MY VEIL

DEGRADED ME

Note:

In that time, women who were out late at night, particularly those without male escorts, were often assumed to be prostitutes.

The night watchmen in Song of Solomon 5:7 mistook the woman for a prostitute. The passage describes them **beating** and **wounding** her and **stripping** her of her veil (some part of her clothing), which is a treatment not typically given to women of good standing in that society.

This suggests they perceived her as someone of low reputation, likely a prostitute.

The watchmen's Violent and degrading actions of **beating**, **bruising**, and **stripping** the woman were not typical for interactions with respectable women.

The woman's veil being taken away is significant, as veils were often worn by women to signify modesty and respectability.

The woman's distress

In the passage further supports the idea that she was being treated as a prostitute against her will.

*Song of Solomon 5:7 The watchmen found me as they patrolled the city. They **hit** me and **hurt** me; the guards on the wall **took away** my veil. NCV*

*Song of Solomon 5:7 The night watchmen **found** me as they made their rounds. They **beat** and **bruised** me and **stripped off** my veil, those watchmen on the walls. NLT*

*Song of Solomon 5:7 The keepers who go about the town **overtook** me; they **gave me blows** and **wounds**; the keepers of the walls **took away** my veil from me. BBE*

THIS LADY'S INTENTION WAS TO SEEK AND FIND HER LOVER AND BE WITH HIM, BUT SHE IS MISTAKEN, MISJUDGED, SMITTEN, WOUNDED WITH REPROACHES AND FALSE ACCUSATIONS AS THOUGH SHE WERE A GUILTY AND EVIL-MINDED WOMAN.

SHE IS SUBJECTED TO ABUSE AND ILL TREATMENT FROM THOSE WHO SHOULD BE HER GUARDIANS. SHE HAD HARD WORK TO ESCAPE, LEAVING HER VEIL BEHIND HER.

APPLICATION

What are the things that stand out from this lady's experience that you can see?

Have we ever suffered hardship and difficulty as a result of failing to respond to the voice and knocking of our lover, Jesus Christ?

Is it possible that sometimes our suffering and hurt are of our own making?

Have we ever thought that some of the hardships that we go through, like being misunderstood, or falsely accused, or hurt, wounded or bruised might be the result of us being:

1. Too busy.
2. Too occupied with other things.
3. Too focused on self and self-interests.
4. Too narrow in our mindset to embrace God's way of speaking to us.

WE NEED TO BE BETTER LISTENERS.

SO, WHAT CAN WE DO TO ADDRESS AND IMPROVE OUR ABILITY TO 'HEAR' OR TO 'RESPOND' TO OUR LORD'S GENTLE PROMPTINGS AND URGINGS OF HIS SPIRIT TO OUR HEARTS?

FIRSTLY,

WE CAN START THE JOURNEY OF DAILY ASKING GOD TO GIVE US A 'HEARING EAR'.

Proverbs 20:12 The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, the Lord hath made even both of them. KJV

Isaiah 50:4 "....He wakens me morning by morning, wakens my ear to listen like one being taught". NIV

SECONDLY,

IN YOUR DAILY DEVOTIONS AND FELLOWSHIP WITH GOD – SPEND SOME OF THE TIME LISTENING AND NOT TALKING.

THIRDLY,

PRACTICE THE SKILL OF LISTENING – HEARING WHAT THOUGHTS AND IDEAS AND SCRIPTURE COMES TO YOU.

FOURTHLY, CONTINUE DOING THE ABOVE UNTIL YOU ARE COMFORTABLE WITH THE PROGRESS.

FIFTHLY, CONTINUE TO MAKE IT A DAILY HABIT SO THAT YOU DO NOT LOSE WHAT YOU HAVE GAINED.

7 The guards found me and struck and wounded me. The watchman on the wall tore off my veil. 8 I adjure you, O women of Jerusalem, if you find my beloved one, tell him that I am sick with love TLB. Amen - Ps. Barry